18

ALTERATION

18.1 INTRODUCTION

Alteration (La'kks/ku) is an art. The same bodice block can be altered to make garments for different people with different figures. The altered block is made according to individual measurements. Alteration of the basic bodice blocks enables us to make different designs and patterns.

18.2 OBJECTIVES

After reading this lesson, you will be able to :

- explain what is alteration;
- develop a pattern with the help of a block;
- make designs in a garment as desired;
- demonstrate the different types of alteration.

18.3 WHAT IS ALTERATION

The changes made in the block made with standard measurements keeping in mind the figure of the person are known as alteration. The alteration done in the block pattern according to figure, style of garment or for placement of pleats, tucks, seams or darts as per fashion is known as pattern alteration. The dress pattern is developed from the standard pattern. The dress pattern can be very easily developed by pattern alteration.

There are many ways of developing the pattern from the standard pattern to fit the style or size of garments. There are -

1. Extending pattern

When the block pattern is extended length wise and widthwise to develop the dress pattern, it is known as extending pattern.

2. Decreasing pattern

When the block pattern is shortened lengthwise or widthwise as per requirement, it is known as decreasing pattern.

3. Dart Lakks/ku

When a dart is transferred from one place to another it is known as dart alteration. The dart is named according to its placement on the block. If the waist dart is to be altered on the pattern, it will be known as waist dart alteration.

4. Yoke style alteration

When the dart is closed and different types of yokes developed according to style, it is know as yoke style alteration.

5. Collar and lapel alteration

Collars are used according to figures, fashion or style. Any change made in the pattern of collar is known as collar and lapel alteration.

6. Sleeve manipulation

The changes made in the sleeve block as per fashion or style are known as sleeve manipulation.

7. Trouser manipulation

When the trouser block is changed to suit the style or fashion, it is known as trouser manipulation e.g. - making jeans, pant, bellbottoms with the trouser block.

DO AND SEE

Extend and decrease the pattern as per directions.

18.4 THE ART OF ALTERATION

Alteration is an art. The block is made according to the body measurements and this block is used for making any changes in the pattern. The same block can be used for making different alterations and new block need not be made every time. There are many types of alterations and they can all be carried out using the same block. Bodice blocks are different for children and ladies. They can be altered as per the design requirements or to suit the figure of the wearer. For example, the same block can be altered to suit a flat chested figure or a full figure. This is the art of alteration. Alteration can be done in the following ways -

i) Sleeve alteration

ii) Dart alteration

iii) Trouser alteration

iv) Collar alteration

All the above alterations can be carried out using the block but detailed information of how alteration can be done by dart transfer, is being given here.

1. Shoulder dart transfer to arm hole dart

i) First of all, make the block.

ii) Mark the dart on the front armhole.

iii) After making the dart, cut it.

iv) Close the shoulder dart

v) In this way the shoulder dart will be closed and will be transferred to the arm hole.

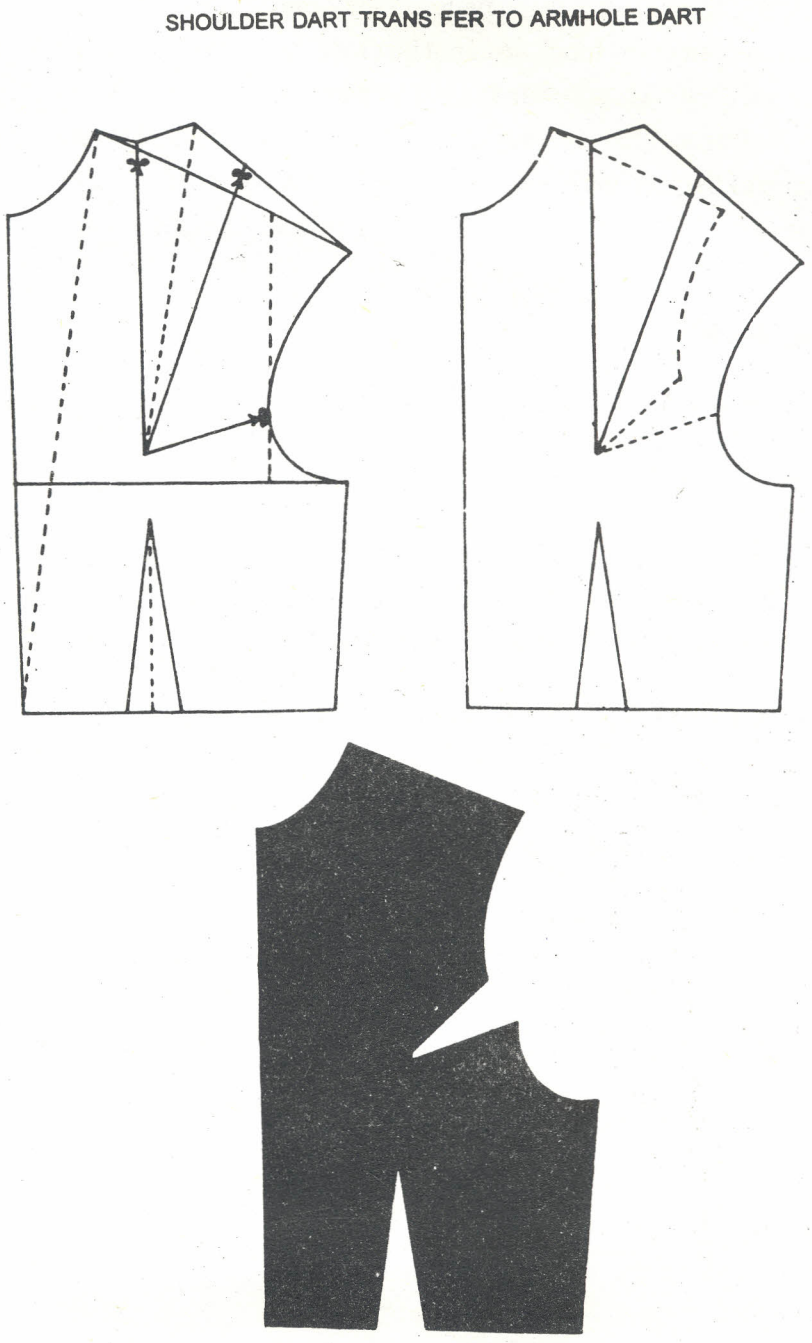


Fig 18.1 Shoulder dart transfer to armhole dart.

2. Shoulder dart transfer to centre front dart

i) Make the bodice block.

ii) Mark the centre front dart and cut it.

iii) Close the shoulder dart. By closing this dart, the centre front dart will be formed.

iv) In this way the shoulder dart can be transferred to the centre front dart.

3. Shoulder dart transfer to waist dart

i) Make the bodice block.

ii) Close the shoulder dart.

iii) Transfer this dart to the waist dart.

iv) In this way the shoulder dart will be closed and its fullness will be transferred to the waist dart.

4. Shoulder dart transfer to side dart

i) Make the bodice block.

ii) Mark the side dart.

iii) Cut the side dart after marking it.

iv) Close the shoulder dart.

v) In this way the shoulder dart can be transferred to the side dart.

5. Shoulder dart transfer to neck dart

i) Make the bodice block.

ii) Mark the neck dart on the neckline.

iii) Cut the dart after marking it.

iv) Close the shoulder dart and open the neck dart.

v) In this way the shoulder dart is transferred to the neck dart.

6. Shoulder dart transfer to centre, armhole or side dart

i) Make the bodice block.

ii) Mark all the three darts on the pattern.

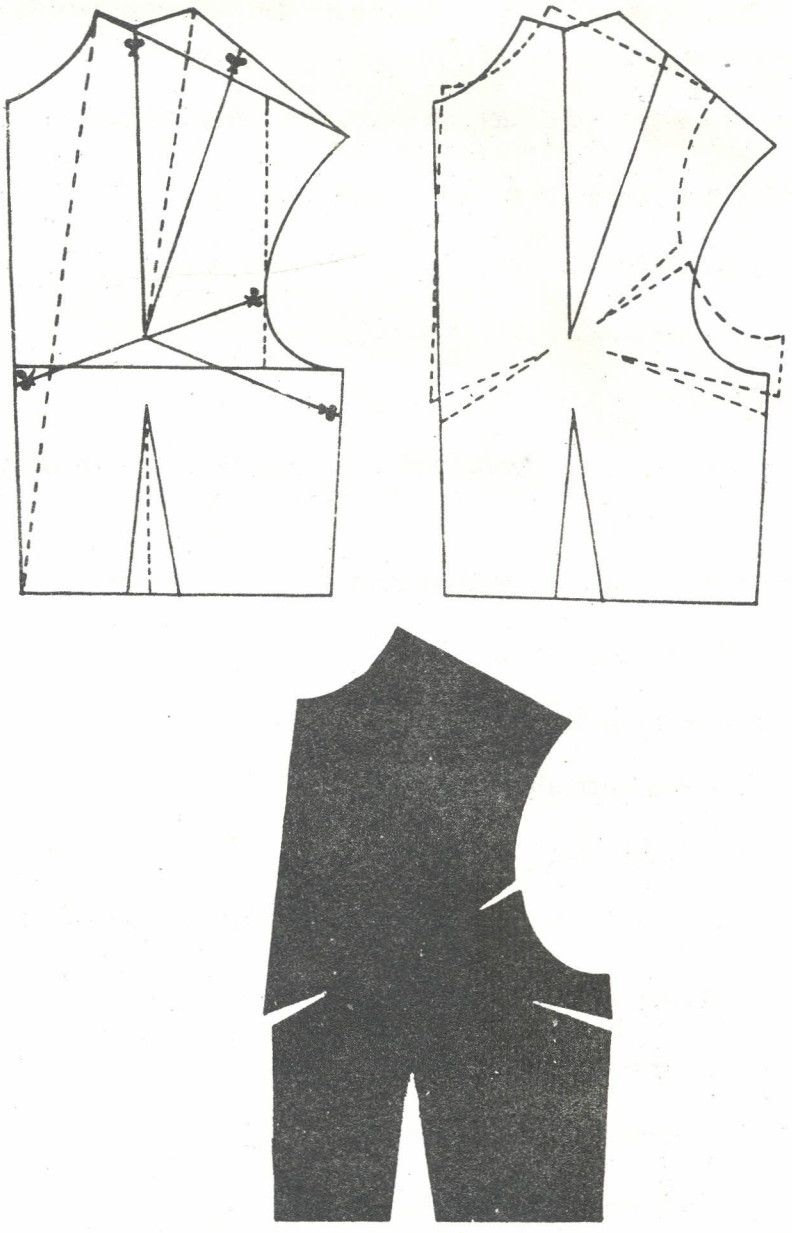


Fig 18.2

iii) Cut along these lines.

iv) Close the shoulder dart.

v) Open the centre, armhole and side darts slightly.

vi) In this way the shoulder dart is transferred to the centre, armhole and side darts.

In this way, the shoulder dart can be transferred to any other place as desired. Darts are used to dispose of fullness in a garment. The sleeve, collar and trouser blocks can similarly be altered to suit the figure of the wearer. This is the art of alteration. It can also be used to create designs.

18.5 WHAT YOU HAVE LEARNT

In this lesson you have learnt what is alteration, how it is done and why alteration is known as an art. You have also learnt how to transfer darts from one place to another.

DO AND SEE

Transfer the various darts as per direction on a bodice block.

18.6 TERMINAL EXERCISE

i) Justify the statement - 'Alteration is an art and is used in making designs'.

ii) Describe in detail how a shoulder dart can be transferred to other darts.